THE 7CS OF COMMUNICATION

Pre-viewing

- *What do you think are the key principles of effective communication?*

- *What do you think are the "7 Cs of communication"?*

Match the following terms with their definitions:

Term		Defintion
1. Clear	c	a. containing all necessary information
2. Concise	f	b. specific and supported by facts
3. Concrete	b	c. message purpose is understandable
4. Correct	e	d. respectful and audience-aware
5. Coherent	g	e. accurate and error-free
6. Complete	a	f. brief and direct
7. Courteous	d	g. logically organized

Watch the following video, then answer the questions below:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BkGJ8B85SKE

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While-viewing

Watch the video, and fill in the gaps in the following table:

C-term	**Definition in your own words**	**Example from video/ your own example**

Answer Key

C-term	**Definition in your own words**	**Example from video/ your own example**
Clarity	Make your message easy to understand; avoid vague or confusing words.	"Submit the report by Friday at 3 PM." (clear)
Conciseness	Keep it short and to the point; avoid unnecessary words.	Instead of: "I was wondering if maybe you could possibly send me the file?" → "Please send me the file."
Concreteness	Use specific facts, figures, or examples; avoid being too general.	"Our sales increased by 20% last quarter" (concrete) instead of "We did well."
Correctness	Use correct grammar, spelling, and facts; be accurate.	Wrong: "The meeting is on Thusday." Correct: "The meeting is on Thursday."

Answer Key Cont'd

Coherence	**Keep ideas well-organized and logical; ensure the message flows smoothly.**	**"First, let's discuss the budget. Then we'll talk about marketing. Finally, we'll plan the launch."**
Completeness	Give all necessary details so the receiver can act on the message.	Incomplete: "Meet me at 7." Complete: "Meet me at Starbucks downtown at 7 PM."
Courtesy	Be respectful and polite; consider the receiver's feelings.	Instead of: "Send me the report now!" → "Could you please send me the report by this afternoon?"

Post-viewing

A. In groups of 3, discuss the following:

- ***Which "C" do you see most frequently used well in presentations?***

Clarity. Most presenters try to make their main idea clear to the audience. They usually explain their topic in simple language so everyone can follow

- **Which is most often neglected?**

- *Conciseness*. Many presenters include too many details or repeat the same points, which makes the presentation long and less engaging.
- Another common one: *Courtesy*. Sometimes presenters don’t pay attention to tone or body language, which can feel rude or unprofessional.

Why might some be harder for speakers to follow?

- ***Completeness*** can be hard because presenters may forget to include background information or assume the audience already knows certain details.
- ***Coherence*** is challenging if the presenter hasn't planned or structured the talk well.
- ***Conciseness*** is difficult because speakers may feel nervous and start talking too much or going off-topic.

Scenarios

A. The following situations break one of the 7Cs of communication. In pairs:

a. Identify the problem

b. Suggest a solution to resolve it

1. **Scenario:** A manager tells the team:

   "We need to handle that thing soon because it's really important for the project."

- **Problem: Clarity** The message is vague. What is "that thing"?
- **Suggested solution :** Clearly state what "that thing is", a problem, for example.

2. **Scenario:** A student giving a presentation says:

"Basically, what I want to say, in other words, is that the point I am trying to make is that studying is important because if you study, you will learn more, and learning more is important."

Problem: Conciseness (Too wordy / repetitive)

Suggested solution : Be conscice and to the point. Don't use unnecessary repetition

3. **Scenario:** A company brochure states:

"Our product is amazing, the best, and will definitely improve your life in many ways."

Problem: Concreteness (Too abstract / lacks evidence)

Suggested solution: Use concrete facts and examples to make it more convincing

4. Scenario: A student emails their professor:

"Dear Dr. John, I will meat you on Thusday for the exam review."

Problem: Correctness (Inaccurate or wrong). Spelling and grammar errors → "meet," "Thursday."

Suggested solution: Check your message for any typos, or grammatical mistakes.

5. Scenario: A speaker says in a presentation:

"Today I will talk about exercise. Exercise is important for health. By the way, I also like pizza. Running helps burn calories. People should sleep enough hours too."

Problem: Coherence (Poor organization). Random ideas, no logical flow.

Suggested solution: Organize your ideas. Rehearse a lot before giving a presentation.

6. Scenario: A text message to a friend:

"Meet me at the place at 7."

Problem: Completeness (Missing important details). Which place? Missing location details.

Suggested solution: Provide all necessary details

7. Scenario: An employee writes to a colleague:

"Send me the report now. You're always late and it's annoying."

Problem: Courtesy (Rude or insensitive). Tone is disrespectful, lacks courtesy.

Suggested solution: Be courteous and address other people politely.

C. In small groups, students create a short 1-minute presentation on a topic of their choice, intentionally incorporating at least **three** of the 7 Cs. The audience listens and identifies which “Cs” are effectively demonstrated, with constructive feedback.